Northwind Labs Employee Handbook

Version 2026.1 — applies to all employees in the Netherlands, Portugal and Poland

1. Welcome to Northwind Labs

Northwind Labs was founded in 2014 in Rotterdam and designs smart water-treatment products for homes and small businesses. Today we employ 340 people across three offices: Rotterdam (headquarters), Lisbon and Kraków. This handbook explains the policies that apply to everyone at Northwind Labs. If anything in this handbook is unclear, please contact the People Team at people@northwind-labs.example.

2. Working hours

A full-time working week at Northwind Labs is 38 hours. We use flexible working hours: you may start your day at any time between 07:30 and 10:00, but everyone is expected to be available during the core hours from 10:00 to 15:00 (local time) for meetings and collaboration. Overtime must be agreed with your manager in advance and is compensated with time off in lieu at a rate of one hour off for every hour worked.

3. Hybrid and remote work

Northwind Labs follows a hybrid model. Employees work from the office at least two days per week. Tuesday and Thursday are team days, when all members of a team are expected in the office. The other days may be worked from home.

Employees may work remotely from another country for up to 20 working days per calendar year. Remote work abroad requires approval from your manager and must be reported to the People Team at least two weeks before you travel, so that tax and insurance rules can be checked. Remote work from outside the European Union is not permitted.

Every employee receives a one-off home office allowance of EUR 400 to buy a desk chair, monitor or other equipment for working from home.

4. Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid annual leave per year. Part-time employees receive leave in proportion to their contracted hours. After every five years of service you receive one extra day of leave per year, up to a maximum of 30 days. Leave requests should be submitted in the HR portal at least two weeks in advance for periods longer than three days.

Up to 5 unused leave days may be carried over to the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used before 31 March; after that date they expire.

5. Sick leave

If you are ill, notify your manager before 09:30 on the first day of absence. A doctor's note is required when you are absent for more than three consecutive working days. When you return to work, please register your recovery in the HR portal.

6. Parental leave

The birth parent receives 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave. The partner of the birth parent, including adoptive parents and same-sex partners, receives 6 weeks of fully paid leave, which can be taken at any time during the first year after the birth or adoption. Additional unpaid parental leave is available according to local law.

7. Learning and development

Each employee has a personal learning budget of EUR 1,500 per calendar year, which can be used for courses, certifications, books and conferences related to their role. In addition, every employee is entitled to two paid learning days per year. Conference attendance requires approval from your manager, and travel for conferences is paid from the learning budget.

8. Business travel and expenses

Expenses must be submitted in the Ledgerly expense app within 30 days of the purchase. A receipt is required for every expense above EUR 25. The following limits apply to business travel:

Expense	Limit
Hotel (standard)	EUR 160 per night
Hotel in London or Paris	EUR 220 per night
Meals while travelling	EUR 45 per day
Flights under 6 hours	Economy class
Flights of 6 hours or longer	Premium economy

Train travel is preferred over flying for journeys of less than five hours.

9. Equipment and IT security

Every employee receives a laptop (MacBook Pro or Lenovo ThinkPad), which is replaced every three years. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all company accounts, and a 1Password account is provided to store passwords. Lock your screen whenever you leave your device. Suspicious emails must be reported to security@northwind-labs.example without clicking any links. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT service desk within 24 hours.

10. Probation and notice periods

New employees have a probation period of two months. After probation, the notice period is one month during the first two years of employment and two months after that.

11. Code of conduct and reporting concerns

We expect everyone to treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect. Discrimination, harassment and bullying are not tolerated. If you experience or witness behaviour that breaks this code, speak to your manager or the People Team. You can also report concerns anonymously through the SafeVoice portal, which is managed by an independent provider. Northwind Labs does not allow retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.